February 25th 1970 MESMEDAATH. No.3

A Neighbourhood News Service.

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MUMS AND/OR WIVES,DON'T FORGET THE MEETING TONIGHT AT THE INFORMATION CENTRE AT 8 PM. YES.TONIGHT,WEDNESDAY.GAG THE KIDS,TURN THE KEY ON YOUR HUSBAND AND THE IRONING. FOR MORE DETAILS SEE YOUR CLUB NEWS FURTHER ON IN MESMEDAATH.

Patrick's piece.

The last day or two,I have met a sad mood in Thamesmead,the feeling that it's simply not worth representing the tenants to the housing authority,the GLC.The signs are not promising...the scaffolding seems to have taken on a new lease of life,far from disappearing further into the site as building progresses,it's back on Coralline Walk. There is news of further rain penetration,lavatories that worked adequately are removed and replaced with new ones,while the troublesome suites remain untouched. The last Association meeting was really an explosion of frustration and complaint,until the business of security was explained late in the evening.

We recall the visit to County Hall,our feeling that perhaps we were making some headway. We now hear rumours of the tenants' clubroom completion being put back to September,of the loss of earnings through modifications to premises,of uncertainty about the opening of the first shops...Easter,Whitsun...? Still the visitors continue their tours,while Health Department officers chase the mice, tenants chase the Association,so it goes on.

Perhaps we are all being far too negative,perhaps we overexaggerate and don't give this exciting new development a chance. And perhaps we paint too gloomy a picture of scruffy walkways,waterlogged landscaping,the number of return visits necessary to keep the whole thing from falling apart. Perhaps... With rents rising next month,with local government elections close at hand.... perhaps not.

Some of the Committee are returning to County Hall this coming Monday,and we all hope to hear news of a more encouraging nature at the Association meeting in the Information Centre Monday night 8 pm. Hope you'll be there. It's your town.

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On a more cheerful note,if you like folk music,Julie Felix is singing on Saturday week,March 7th at Avery Hill College.Tickets and information from 854-8888. It's at 7.30 pm,tickets 10/-,12/-.

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Thanks to the Electricity Board for restoring the supply yesterday lunch-time. It was off for about an hour. As it happened,our baked apples were alright Jack,but we realized how dependent we are on the Electricity Board for our heating.

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Some of you,indeed many of you will have heard that the Abbey School are holding a Spring Bazaar at the school at 3 pm on Thursday March 19th.Admission 3d adults,children free. There will be another meeting for interested parents on Tuesday March 10th at 7.30 pm. Any contributions will be welcome,tinned goods sweets,fancy goods,white heffalumps,things good as new,books & comics,toys in good nick,things for the lucky dip (about 6d worth) will be welcome at any reasonable time at the school. Please mark each item with a suggested price. Wool and material remanants would be welcome. For those who can and want to get

together to make preparations,one classroom is available from 1.30 pm to 3.30 pm every Wednesday. Toddlers will be welcome if they don't wander off!

From the Health Visitor.....

Child Welfare Clinics are now held,as many of you know,on Tuesdays from 11 am to 12 pm at the Health Centre in Lensbury Way. From March 6th they will be transferred to Fridays 2 pm - 4 pm as more time is needed to cope with all the new mothers and children coming into Thamesmead.

Mothercraft and Relaxation classes will be held on Fridays at 10 am at the Health Centre.

I shall always be pleased to discuss with and advise mothers on infant feeding and management; the Immunisation programme which is so important for the childrens good health; family planning facilities in the Bexley Borough,and any other relevant matters.

I will also be seeing your children in Abbey School at their medical examinations and routine hygiene inspections.

You can contact me at the Health Centre at Lensbury Way,where I am based.

Mrs E.Jones S.R.N. S.C.M.
Health Visitor.

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Some of you might like to know that the Service Committee of the Abbey Wood and Thamesmead British Legion meet at William Temple Church,Eynsham Drive each Wednesday evening from 8 pm until 9 pm. The committee is composed of competent people in the field of Welfare who will be pleased to assist Ex-servicemen,women,and their dependents who have need,and who live in Thamesmead and Abbey Wood.

P Mepstead,Hon Sec. 17a Bostall Hill,SE2 854-8200.

CRIME....and its prevention. After the last meeting of the Community Association, I won't say it's been more difficult to get into people's homes. I have noticed a number of front doors with Chubb locks,chains,the works. Looks as if I'll have to rely on people actually letting me in. Let's hope the villains have also taken note. What they are taking,however,are liberties with vehicles. A fourpenny car door or boot lock is,alas,poor security for tools worth pounds of our money,spare wheels and tyres,even batteries. Please be safe rather than sorry,and don't leave any kind of valuables, especially the items I've mentioned,in your car if parked unattended. Police Constable Ronald Lathwell told me that this sort of theft is occurring,and asks us to help him prevent a lot of bother and inconvenience all round. Don't forget,he can be contacted through Belvedere Police Station Tel No. Erith (38) 32214 for non urgent calls,and in emergency dial 999 and ask for Police.

You may have seen a news item on,I think,Nationwide Tv,reporting on the wiles of salesmen anxious to sell you Home Learning Systems (or if you like,about £160 worth of "advice",books etc. We know they have been in this area,along with sellers of first aid kits and 1001 other odds and ends. Whether the Home Learning Systems men have any success with you is up to you..of course. But you have been warned.The particular organisation named in the programme was "GROLIER". OK?

MUMS THE WORD,or A Word to the Wives.....

Fancy a night out? then why not join our Wives Club (is it the same as the Mums' Club? Yes it is. Thanks.) The next meeting is to be held today Wednesday February 25th at 8 o clock in the Information Centre. Mrs Gray is coming to show us some interesting methods of cake decoration.

The club will meet on the last wednesday of the month. We are hoping to have something different and interesting every month, for example,a lingerie party,keep fit,wig party,makeup demonstration,wine tasting,mystery tour,Tupperware etc. Membership fee will be 2/-,and 1/6 per meeting attended. Anything goes for a laugh and a giggle,so come along and see for yourselves.

Mrs Rendall.

The Committee members.....

Mrs Rendall,116 Binsey Walk,Chairman (or Chairwoman)
Mrs Crabbe, 95 Coralline Walk,Treasurer
Miss Claire Chisholm,c/o 4 Coralline Walk,Secretary
Mrs Lambert,12 Maplin House,
Mrs Rogers,3 Clewer House,
Mrs Fillery,95 Lensbury Way.
Mrs Jones,Health Visitor.

Pssst!

Rumour has it that some people still don't know that there is a dentist,who may be contacted through the Health Centre,Lensbury Way,Tel No.310-3281.

YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH YOUTH

Thamesmead Youth now has a committee,John Barwick,29 Coralline Walk,Chairman,
Lynette East,112 Binsey Walk,Secretary,
Fred James,56 Coralline,Treasurer,
Lynda McMahon,112 Lensbury Way,
Peter Goodair,106 Coralline,
Susan Turley,27 Clewer House.

The Committee is endeavouring to secure the use of the Abbey School for regular meetings,is working on ideas for a programme. The Community Association voted an initial grant of £10 from general funds to help the club make a start. If you would like to know more of what is happening,contact the Chairman 310-4864 or any of the Committee. Better still,come to a general meeting for teenagers to be held at the Information Centre on Wednesday March 4th at 8 pm, a chance to pool ideas,get things done. DO YOUR THING,IT'S YOUR SCENE,SEE YOU MARCH 4TH.

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NEW VOTERS....ARE YOU BETWEEN 17 AND 21? IF SO,THIS CONCERNS YOU. BEXLEY BOROUGH COUNCIL IS ARRANGING TWO CIVIC "WELCOMES" FOR YOU. If you are a young person coming on to the Register of Electors for the first time and would like to know more about the work of your Council,please send me a postcard by 27th February 1970, asking for an invitation to one of the Welcomes. Let me have your name,address and date of birth in BLOCK LETTERS, and advise me which of the Welcomes you wish to attend. These will be held on Friday 13th March 1970 at Erith School,Avenue Road, Erith and on Friday 20th March 1970 at Hurstmere Secondary School for boys,Hurst Road,Sidcup 7.30 pm - 10.45 pm. Dress will be informal and the evenings' programmes will be varied and interesting with free refreshments.

Town Hall,
Erith,Kent.

Clive Dennis
Town Clerk

In view of the need to reply by the 27th,should you be a bit late,you could try ringing through to the Town Clerk's Dept,Town Hall Erith,Tel No.303 7777. (Ed.)

Thamesmead 1970

I understand that the new Thamesmead film,in which the Community Association had a hand,is to be previewed the first week in March,and should be available for showing to interested groups later in the month. Should be interesting!

Hands Up

How many of you realize that there is to be a local council by-election on Thursday March 5th? Our nearest polling station is St Marys Hall,New Road,Abbey Wood,and it will be open from 8 am until 9 pm. (New Road...how to get there..over the level crossing,turn left at the main road,cross over,past the flower shop and it's the first turning on the right)

The candidates,one Conservative,one Labour are:-

Conservative:Dennis Hague.
Labour :Miss Shirley Gadsdon.

The By-election is caused by the resignation of Borough Councillor D.Warner. I understand that Bexley Borough Council is all-conservative,apart from Labour Aldermen. Talking to representatives of both parties,the message came across loud and clear,don't start bloomin' grumbling unless you bother to vote one way or the other in this election.

WHO CAN VOTE? Those of voting age who arrived in Thamesmead on or before October 10th 1969. Residents arriving after this date will still be registered on the lists of the boroughs where they used to live. In order to vote in the GLC elections in April,those arriving after October 10th will have to return to their old boroughs to vote. If this has got you completely confused,you can ring the Electoral Registration Officer at the Town Hall,tel No. 303 7777. Next month we will feature detailed information on the activities of the local ward and constituency parties.

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For the record,our MP for Erith and Crayford,Jim Wellbeloved holds "surgeries" at Norman Dodds House,315 Bexley Road,Erith on the last Saturday each month (you've had it this month) from 10.30 am to 12.30 pm. No appointment necessary.

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Having been called on at dead of night,I realize the need for public telephones on Thamesmead. When asked,the GPO said that it was a matter awaiting planning permission from the GLC. The GLC have been asked to investigate,which they are doing,and we look forward to having our first public telephone. I hope,meanwhile that in emergencies,those of us who have telephones will help out.

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Adventure playgrounds are a super idea,but they need to be thought out. Thamesmead children,including under 5s,who don't necessarily know better,have been inventing their own adventures,on ladders on the top walkways,on scaffolding,with plant and

equipment on the site. For the time being it is inevitable that the site should be more exciting/dangerous than we would all like. I hope we won't wait for a nasty accident before thinking out for ourselves where responsibility for children's safety lies, given unavoidable dangers on the site.

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Talking Shop.

What should the churches or the church be doing in Thamesmead? What do residents expect from the churches in a new development like Thamesmead? Or,what does it mean to be a Christian in this situation,or what are you going to do about it anyway? These could be some of the issues,among many others that might be raised at two informal discussions on Wednesday March 18th at 8.30 pm. Some local clergy,Anglican,Methodist, Congregational and Roman Catholic are concerned that you,the residents should start asking these questions,and try to find some answers. If you are able to come to one of these meetings,please do. They will be completely informal,unstructured,and those who come will decide what to talk about. A lot of time will be spent getting to know one another,and this in itself is very important.

The two homes offering hospitality on this occasion,(it is hoped that groups will move around to different people's houses) are 116 Binsey Walk Mr and Mrs Rendall,and 27 Coralline Walk Mr and Mrs Christie. Hope to see you there,and our thanks to the Rendalls and the Christies.

Patrick Forbes.

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Latest statistics reaching us are that 121 linear block homes are occupied,89 homes in the point blocks,and 42 houses. And,you'll never guess,there are 3.2 people to each unit of accomodation. So now you know.

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Please,please,please don't forget to come to the Community Association meeting at 8 pm this coming Monday March 2nd in the information centre.

Some more routine information

There is a Citizens Advice Bureau in the Information Centre. It is open at the following times Mondays 9.30 am - 12.30 pm
Thursdays 7.15 pm - 8.45 pm Tel No. 854-5223
The Health Centre telephone Number is 310-3281
The Abbey Primary School telephone number is 310-2827 Headmaster Mr B Roach
Information Officer Cary Grant (Bexley) & W Cosedge (Greenwich) 854 5223,5224
GLC Community Officer David Llewellyn 854 5645
GLC District Office (Housing) 119 Elmstead Lane,Chislehurst,Kent. Tel No.857-2241
GLC Area Housing Office,140 Eynsham Drive (by the shops) Tel No.854-8084
Head Caretaker,Thamesmead,1 Coralline Walk,Mr W Brown.
Thamesmead Community Association:
Chairman Jack Gibbons,107 Coralline Walk,310-2508.
Vice-Chairman Jim Murray,109 Coralline Walk,310-2286.
Secretary Jack Goodair,106 Coralline Walk,310-1986.
Treasurer Patrick Forbes,4 Coralline Walk,310 -3860.
Mr and Mrs Billis 94 Lensbury Way
Mr Jolly 15 Clewer House.Mr Rogers 3 Clewer House.
Social Committee chairman Mrs Murray,109 Coralline walk.
For Midwives,District Nurses and Home Helps,enquiries to Bexley Health and Welfare Department,9 Brampton Road,Bexleyheath,Tel No. 303 7777.
A warm welcome to Sunday School at Abbey School,Sundays 10 am (over 4 years) and an adult service at 11 am (for all the family).

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Perspicacious readers will doubtless have noticed that there is little detail this month about the doings of the Community Association earlier this month.It would be great if all the rest of the members could come this next Monday at 8 pm,leaving me more space for other matters. Incidentally,if you are bursting with news,views,that you want to air,please let me have them by March 15th at the latest (4 Coralline Walk).

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We welcome a new arrival in Thamesmead,Mr Harvey,the GLC's Resident Estate Officer,who, we hear,will be operating from the office in Eynsham Drive. He will be living in Lensbury Way.

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If you should have a leaflet about the Crees Scheme (Good Neighbour scheme) put through your door,don't feed it to the dog,fill it up as best you can.We'll be along to collect it from you and answer any queries you may have about the scheme and how you might be able to help or use the scheme.Thanks. Patrick Forbes & Claire Chisholm.

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Colonel Ponsonby-Fitzcrunge to Vicar "I must say,no offence of course,that the standards of the clergy are really reaching rock bottom these days."
Smooth Vicar:"Trouble is,we've only the laity to choose from..."(Not original) You decide whether it's applicable.

Produced by Patrick Forbes,4 Coralline Walk.